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Student Portrait Sheet (SPS)

In SPS Student has to demonstrate the following attributes:

- 21st Century Skills
 - Collaborator
 - Communicator
 - Creative and Critical Thinker
 - Ethical/Global Citizen
 - Goal-Directed & Resilient Individual
 - Innovator
 - Leader
 - Problem Solver
- Additional information about Portrait of a Graduate
 - Note: The Student Portrait Sheet will evaluate applicants on the broad skills listed above and not each listed bullet given below in each category. However, the information below provides deeper information to better understand the skills listed above.

What skills does a student need to write in the Student Portrait Sheet?

Do not restrict yourself to only middle-school activities. Include anything and everything you have done in your life so far. Nothing is too small to mention. What you think is too small may be the one that catches the attention of the admissions committee. Sit with your parents and siblings to prepare the notes on what you have done so far. Sometimes students forget many things they have done, but parents and siblings may remember them. This is very important. Remember, the SPS carries a lot of

weightage and taking it lightly may be the worst thing you can do to yourself in getting admission into TJ.



Communicator

There may be overlaps in the responses you write for the categories given below.

- **Applies effective reading skills to acquire knowledge and broaden perspectives:** Include: the books, magazines, newspaper, and on-line material you read to broaden your knowledge above the classroom material.
- **Employs active listening strategies to advance understanding:** Include: presentations, seminars, webinars, knowledge-based TV and online resources you attend live or watch to broaden your knowledge above the classroom material.
- **Speaks in a purposeful manner to inform, influence, motivate, or entertain listeners:** Include: science/Tech Ed. project presentations you made; and Debate and Model United Nations (MUN) club and awareness campaign participations.
- **Incorporates effective writing skills for various purposes and audiences to convey understanding and concepts:** Include: Science/Tech. Ed. project reports you wrote, any stories, articles and poems you wrote which were published and unpublished but shared with peers.
- **Uses technological skills and contemporary digital tools to explore and exchange ideas:** Include any blogs or websites or social media platforms you maintain or use to communicate/exchange your ideas.



Collaborator

- **Respects divergent thinking to engage others in thoughtful discussion.**
- **Demonstrates the ability to work interdependently within a group to promote learning, increase productivity, and achieve common goals.**
- **Analyzes and constructs arguments and positions to ensure examination of a full range of viewpoints.**
- **Seeks and uses feedback from others to adapt ideas and persist in accomplishing difficult tasks.**

All the above are interrelated. Hence, you can merge your response to all in one common write-up. In case, if you participated in multiple number of group activities and the space permits, then write about each one of them. If there is a space limit, first list the group activities you participated and your role in them and then write your general experiences in them.

Include all group projects/activities you have done so far or currently participating, either inside or outside school. These include but not limited to MathCounts, Science Olympiad, Math Olympiad, Robotics related activities, E-Cybermission, Debate team, Model United Nations (MUN) club, Literary or Art club, Group Social Service activities etc. State your role (Leader or an active team member) and explain how you interacted with others collaboratively and respecting other team member's opinions. Explain how you changed your opinions after listening to other points of view? Explain how considering and implementing other team member's opinions helped to make a project/goal a success. It is okay to confess that you were originally heavy headed but realized and changed later. In case, if you have changed your thinking then mention what led to the change.



Ethical and Global Citizen

There may be overlaps in the responses you write for the categories given below. If you won awards/recognitions you need to mention them without gloating too much about them.

- **Acknowledges and understands diverse perspectives and cultures when considering local, national, and world issues:** Mention about your friendships with fellow students across different ethnicities, religions and languages and how it helped you learn different cultures and customs and to become a global citizen. Mention various events and festivals you celebrate that cut across different religions and cultures. **Never disclose your religion or ethnicity explicitly.**
- **Contributes to solutions that benefit the broader community:** Write about things you have done related to big problems such as bullying, and also in helping struggling students to get better by tutoring them in school or outside school, helping senior citizens in writing e-mails to their loved ones, rising funds for worthy causes related to hunger, disease, education for poor people in US or other countries etc.
- **Communicates effectively in multiple languages to make meaningful connections:** In case, if you are taking Spanish as the foreign language in school explain how it helped you to make a connection with Spanish speaking students in school and outside school. Also talk about how your knowledge of other languages helped you to develop friendships with other students in school and outside school and in other countries. Mention about your big-sib relation with orphans or other less fortunate students in US/other countries due to your knowledge of other languages. Mention how this relation benefited the sib and you.
- **Promotes environmental stewardship:** Mention environmental club or environment related science project activities you participated. Mention any voluntary activities related to cleaning the trash in your school and neighborhood and bringing awareness about clean environment in the community. Some class projects include testing water quality in lakes and creeks. It is a good idea to include them. The boy/girl scouts are also involved in these activities.
- **Understands the foundations of our country and values our rights, privileges, and responsibilities:** Reading books and articles or watching videos related to founding of America, American Civil Rights movements (equal rights to all, voting rights to women and African

Americans etc.), Equal pay for all for the equal job regardless of the gender and race. Mention: your belief that voting is an important civic duty for all to elect the best candidates for the job, your strong belief in abiding to the laws (upholding the US constitution) without prejudice and in creating a just, peaceful and harmonious society.

- **Demonstrates empathy, compassion, and respect for others:** Give examples where you have demonstrated empathy and compassion towards poor, sick, weak and disabled including animals. Do you have examples to demonstrate that you respect people with different points of view on any issue?
- **Acts responsibly and ethically to build trust and lead:** Have you faced any ethical dilemmas in life? And explain how you responded? The dilemmas may be the ones associated with academic, monetary and social issues.



Creative and Critical Thinker

There may be overlaps in the responses you write for the categories given below. If you won awards or received recognitions you need to mention them without gloating too much about them.

- **Engages in problem solving, inquiry, and design of innovative solutions to overcome obstacles to improve outcomes:** Describe any Tech Ed. (Rocket design or Balsa Wood car design or Robotic design) projects and FLL/FTC/VEX Robotics projects you have done, which do not have unique solutions. Write the innovativeness you have incorporated in your design to overcome limitations/problems. Writing computer programs or creating apps for a specific application also go here. Write what is innovative in your program/app.
- **Uses information in novel and creative ways to strengthen comprehension and deepen awareness:** Describe the research you have done to gain a broader understanding on the Science/Engineering/Technology Projects in the school and outside the school, Science Fare Projects, Science Olympiad topics etc. You can also mention reading books, magazines like Popular Science and reading newspaper articles to expand your knowledge.

- **Demonstrates divergent and ingenious thought to enhance the design-build process:** Describe any Tech Ed. (Rocket or Balsa Wood car design or Robotics) projects and FLL/FTC/VEX Robotics projects, which do not have any unique answers. Writing computer programs or creating apps for a specific application also go here.
- **Expresses thought, ideas, and emotions meaningfully through the arts:** Your artistic (line drawing, coloring, music, dance, essay and magazine article writing, poetry) activities and accomplishments should be mentioned here.
- **Evaluates ideas and information sources for validity, relevance, and impact:** Hands-on activities you have done at home or part of the science/technology club at school to validate a scientific/engineering/technical concept, which is either well known or your original idea. This can include writing computer programs and building gadgets. Sometimes research may be done to validate an idea.
- **Reasons through and weighs evidence to reach conclusions:** It overlaps with the above. It means you are a person who thinks logically/analytically and look at evidence (in the form of data) before coming to a conclusion. Include activities where you have demonstrated these traits.



Goal-Directed and Resilient Individual

- **Engages in healthy and positive practices and relationships to promote overall physical and mental well-being:** Write about all sports activities and any yoga and meditation activities you are engaged in. You can also put volunteer activities at libraries, places of worship, peer tutoring etc. and claim that volunteering and helping others make you happy. Mention getting trophies/recognitions for excellence in these endeavors.
- **Persists to accomplish difficult tasks and to overcome academic and personal barriers to meet goals:** You need to put activities which many people thought are not possible to accomplish but you persisted and make them happen. These can be projects done running against the clock to meet the deadlines and accomplished the original goals successfully. These need not be only STEAM activities anything else is also fine.
- **Uses time and financial resources wisely to set goals, complete tasks, and manage projects:** Write about projects and activities you were able to complete by running against the clock by

proper time management and smart decisions. You can mention about your time management skills to participate in several activities and excelling in them. Also include any activities (such as robot or rocket construction) where you controlled the budget to a minimum by making wise (innovative) decisions.

- **Shows strong understanding and belief of self to engage in reflection for individual improvement and advocacy:** This is where you mention about how you changed your habits and attitudes by reflecting on past experiences, where you made mistakes. It means learning life lessons through bad experiences. Did you evolve in your thought process through the past experiences? If so give examples. Do you advise others based on your past experiences to help them not to fail?

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Innovator:

Traits Of Innovators:

- Creative Gurus:
- Continuous Reflection: Open to question their idea and the direction of the project and willing to move on to a newer idea, if necessary, until success is achieved. Willing to identify uncertainties.
- Unattached Exploration: Never strongly attached to an idea and stay open to exploring different possible directions before closing in on a single option.
- Action Oriented: Good with converting fundamental work into an experimental design, building a prototype, and running the experiment.
- Opportunity Focused: Ability to see opportunities in different directions and share with their teams several possible routes for the project.
- Mental Resilience: Adapt positively to adversity and do not let challenges to defeat them. Reacts positively to unexpected information or events, and meaningful comments or suggestions
- Intellectual Humility: Open to learning by acknowledging the limits of own knowledge.
- Highly Confident and Courageous: Do not mind facing the risk of refusal and failure. Driven and motivated by change.

Use STEAM oriented or any other activities as supporting evidence examples.

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LEADER:

Bring out the following characteristics you demonstrated in the write-up with examples.

- Communicates effectively with the team
- A good leader has patience, stability, confidence, kindness, and an ability to deal with other people amicably
- Delegates clear responsibilities to team members based on their strengths
- Does not do everything by himself, meaning there are no monopolies. He/she splits the tasks between the team members in both the creative and implementation process of a project
- A good leader does not have ego, open-minded and considers everyone's opinions including criticism. They also prevent conflict between team members while not having an ego
- A good leader solves conflicts between team members and maintains harmony in the team
- A good leader encourages and supports his/her team members and steps in when there is a need. If someone is sick or unavailable, a leader will fill in. He/she is ready to accept responsibilities if a situation arises. A good leader always strives to achieve the common goal of the group
- A good leader gives credit to other team members for their efforts and success including coaches and mentors
- A good leader is decisive and takes the initiative to change the direction if needed to complete the job successfully
- A good leader is ethical and never breaks the rules and steers the group in the right direction.

Supporting evidence can be provided using any leadership role in group activities including but not limited to leadership positions in school clubs, Student government, school souvenir committee, youth group in your place of worship, social service activities, boys/girls scouts, STEM related activities etc.

Problem Solver:

A good problem solver has the following Qualities:

- Has a clear understanding of every aspect and issue associated with the problem.
- Thinks out of the box, meaning that no one else in the group thought in the same way to solve the problem. Does not follow traditional or run-of-the-mill methods to create an effective solution.
- Will consider the advantages (pros/pluses) and risks (cons/minuses) involved in each solution to a problem.
- Comes up with practical and ethical solutions. These solutions are easily implementable without too much effort.
- Considers the economic factors involved with implementing the solutions. Comes up with cost-effective solutions to meet requirements, even if they are somewhat less effective compared to expensive solutions.

- Builds consensus on the acceptance of a solution within a group. Convinces other group members to accept the solution using supporting evidence, which includes the solution's pros and cons.

Use STEAM oriented or any other activities as supporting evidence examples.